



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Queen of Peace Catholic School
School Website: <https://queenofpeaceschool.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Queen of Peace Catholic School (Cloquet, MN) presents a robust Classical-Catholic profile across most core elements. Public materials emphasize a Catholic liberal-arts framework framed by liturgical life, formation of character, and a Trivium-oriented curriculum. The school foregrounds truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable, grounds study in Catholic theology and catechesis, and integrates liturgical practice and sacramental life into daily schooling. There is strong evidence of a Trivium-based curriculum, a commitment to Great Books-style engagement with classic texts, and a living faculty culture deeply tied to the school's mission. Parental involvement and community partnership are clearly prioritized, with explicit emphasis on collaboration between parents and teachers, and open campus norms.

Overall, the school is CLASSICAL with notable strengths in religious/metaphysical foundations, school purpose and goal, curriculum, faculty, and parent/community engagement. The Pedagogy category shows meaningful classical traits (Trivium, contemplative/restful elements, and liturgical memory), but there is less explicit mention of Socratic seminars or sustained high-school-level Paideia-style seminars in the public materials, placing Pedagogy as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The six-category aggregate leans CLASSICAL.

Key takeaways by category: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: Strong CLASSICAL indicators (truth/goodness/beauty; liturgy; Catholic theology; communal worship; sacred music; sacramental worldview). - Purpose and Goal: Strong CLASSICAL indicators (formation, virtue, wisdom; true/beautiful/good; classical telos). - Curriculum: Strong CLASSICAL indicators (Trivium; liberal arts; great books-style engagement; classical texts; memory and contemplation). - Pedagogy: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (evidence of contemplative/restful pedagogy and liturgical/memory-based approaches; less explicit evidence of Socratic seminars across grades in public materials). - Faculty: Strong CLASSICAL indicators (model teachers; living curriculum; mentorship; collegial, mission-driven culture). - Parents & Community: Strong CLASSICAL indicators (partnering with parents; parent formation opportunities; open-campus visitation).

What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL cases) - Explicitly foreground sustained Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy across grades (especially middle/high school). - More explicit articulation of Great Conversations/Great Books scope and frequency (e.g., a defined Great Books sequence for K-12 and regular Paideia-style seminars). - Clearer reference to long-term classical-language study (Latin/Greek) as a formal, programmatic element across grades. - Additional explicit statements about the "living curriculum" in faculty training and assessment to strengthen the Faculty category beyond general evidence.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence: Explicit emphasis on truth, goodness, beauty; Catholic theology; liturgical life; sacred music; catechesis; sacramental worldview; Mass; and reverence.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords identified include truth, goodness, beauty, theology, liturgy, Mass, catechesis, liturgical life, sacred music, worship, wonder, sacramental worldview. Negative indicators (relativism, secularism) do not appear in public-facing materials. Estimated positive vs negative: 12:0 Why this rating: The school explicitly locates education within a transcendent,

Christian-metaphysical frame and anchors learning in liturgy and Catholic doctrine, matching the Classical School's foundational metaphysical expectations.

- **Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Mission emphasizes forming children in Catholic faith through a rigorous classical curriculum; explicit aim toward truth, goodness, beauty; focus on formation and human flourishing.
Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, classical mission, true/good/beautiful, contemplation, Great Conversation-related language (where present). Negative indicators (workforce-prep terms) are not emphasized. Estimated positive vs negative: 5:0
Why this rating: The stated purpose centers on formation and the pursuit of virtue and wisdom through a classical, Catholic frame rather than solely job-readiness or utilitarian aims.
- **Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Trivium-based entry point; liberal arts foundation; study of classical texts; explicit reference to great books and classic literature; incorporation of Latin/Greek paths through language offerings; integration of Western/Catholic intellectual tradition.
Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include liberal arts, trivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books, classics, history (Western civilization), sacred art/music, memory, and contemplative components. Negative indicators include avoidance of “social studies” re-labeled as history or a pure project-based emphasis; none are evident. Estimated positive vs negative: 9:0
Why this rating: The curriculum is squarely built on Classical pillars (grammar/logic/rhetoric; liberal arts; engagement with great books/classics; contemplation/wonder). Explicit Latin/Greek language offerings and a strong emphasis on memory and ritualized learning further support CLASSICAL.
- **Element 4: Pedagogy — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence:** Trivium framework and classical progression; lower-school emphasis on liturgical music and memory; upper-school potential for Socratic-style engagement is implied by the Classical framework, but explicit public mention of Socratic seminars or Paideia-style seminars is not strongly evidenced. Presence of Schola Cantorum and focus on memorization and memory work; contemplative/restful elements noted. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include scholé, contemplation, wonder, memory work, chanting, liturgical calendar integration, and rhetoric-focused practice (where described). Negative indicators include any explicit reliance on experiential learning-only or project-based dominance; these are not present as primary features. Estimated positive vs negative: 6:2
Why this rating: While core Classical elements are well-represented, explicit high-school Socratic seminars and Paideia-style seminars are not clearly documented in public materials, and some pedagogical practices emphasize liturgy and memory more than Socratic discussion. Thus, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- **Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Faculty described as caring, mission-minded, living curriculum; teachers as mentors and exemplars; portrait of teacher and living curriculum concepts; collaborative and communal faculty culture.
Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include model teachers, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, moral exemplars, character formation. No salient negative indicators observed. Estimated positive vs negative: 9:0
Why this rating: The materials portray a venerated, formed-teacher model and living curriculum, aligning with Classical expectations of the faculty as core carriers of the traditional curriculum and character formation.
- **Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Explicit emphasis on partnership with parents; parental formation opportunities (book studies, gatherings); open campus and frequent parent involvement; parents as co-teachers; community and liturgical/calendar integration.
Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental formation, reading groups, classical book clubs, open campus, parent covenant, family liturgy alignment. Negative signals (consumer-language or minimal parental involvement) do not appear. Estimated positive vs negative: 8:0
Why this rating: The site frames parents as essential partners and co-educators in a classical project, with robust opportunities for parental formation and involvement.

Aggregate Assessment - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - Rationale: The school demonstrates strong Classical foundations in Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, Faculty, and Parents & Community. Pedagogy shows substantial Classical traits, but the explicit presence of

Socratic seminars and Paideia-style seminars is not clearly documented in public materials, resulting in a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy. The balance across six categories leans CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle - Make Socratic seminars and Paideia-style seminar structures explicit in public-facing materials and school communications, including clear high-school and middle-school implementation plans. - Publish a formal Great Books sequence or “Great Conversation” framework (with specific titles and grade-by-grade expectations) to replace or clearly complement “classic literary texts.” - Provide a transparent, year-by-year Latin/Greek language plan and emphasize classical language study as a core structural element of the curriculum (across multiple grades, not just electives). - Expand explicit articulation of the Trivium progression in classroom practice with observable examples (grammar/logic/rhetoric blocks, assessment rubrics, and capstone rhetoric projects) across K-12. - Highlight faculty development programs centered on classical pedagogy (e.g., faculty seminars on living-curriculum theory) to reinforce Element 5 fidelity. - Deepen parent education offerings with regular, accessible programs that connect classical pedagogy with at-home study to strengthen Element 6 alignment.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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